STEPHY RIEGA ESCALANTE

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EDUCATION

The University of Chicago 2026
Graduate Student-at-Large: Real Analysis (A−)

Pontifical Catholic University of Peru (PUCP) Lima, Peru
Specialization Certificate in Data Science for Social Sciences and Public Management 2025
BA in Economics, GPA 3.86/4.00 (ranked 3rd of 73) *(GPA and grades converted by Scholaro)* 2022

Graduate coursework: Advanced Econometrics: Cross-Section and Panel Data (A); Design and Evaluation of Social Policies (A)
Selected coursework: Econometrics I (A); Microeconomics II (A); Advanced Topics in Microeconomics (A; causal ML); Statistical Inference (A); Applied Statistics (A); Applied Statistics (A); Mathematics for Economics and Finance III (A)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Chicago Crime Lab and Education Lab Chicago, IL
Research Analyst *November 2023 – Present*

Policing Leadership Academy (PLA) – Multi-site RCT evaluating commander-level leadership training in U.S. police departments, building on Kapustin, Neumann & Ludwig (2022). *With Prof. Max Kapustin.*

- Led randomization and the impact analysis of World Management Survey (WMS) outcomes, using paired-t, Wilcoxon and sign-flip permutation tests with bootstrap effect sizes and minimum detectable effects.
- Produced a recurring data-collection monitoring report; used double-scored interviews to decompose score variance, correct for attenuation bias and inform statistical power (Bloom et al., 2019).
- Built a national FBI–ACS dataset for eligibility screening; quantified how the SRS-to-NIBRS transition (FBI, 2015) affects homicide comparability for project eligibility.

Personalized Learning Initiative (PLI) – Large-scale multi-site RCTs evaluating high-dosage tutoring in U.S. public schools, building on Guryan et al. (2023). *With Prof. Jens Ludwig and Dr. Fatemeh Momeni.*

- Led the Miami-Dade site impact analysis across three cohorts (SY24–SY26), from data pipelines to impact estimates; its robustness protocols were adopted across all 8 U.S. sites in the project.
- Detected understated clustered standard errors in the shared estimation code and re-specified inference with multi-way clustering (Cameron, Gelbach & Miller, 2011); integrated it into the project's randomization inference under rerandomization designs (Morgan & Rubin, 2012).
- Ran prognostic (predicted-outcome) balance tests à la Bicalho et al. (2022), bounded effects with Lee (2009) bounds, and translated SD effects into years and months of learning (Hill et al., 2008).
- Linked tutor survey data to the analysis sample to examine cross-site variation in impacts by tutor characteristics.

Group for the Analysis of Development (GRADE) Lima, Peru
Research Assistant (Apr 2023 – Oct 2023); Research Intern (Feb 2021 – Jul 2021) *Partner: IDB*

- Contributed to the design and pre-analysis plan of a remote math tutoring RCT in 60 schools in Ayacucho, a high-poverty Andean region of Peru. *With Prof. Juan León Jara Almonte.*
- Co-developed and validated survey measures (reliability and internal consistency) of academic beliefs.
- Worked on an impact evaluation of labor formalization interventions for micro-entrepreneurs in high-violence neighborhoods in Brazil. *With Prof. Martin Valdivia.*
- Estimated event-study models of fertility in Peru around the FIFA World Cup, using Peru's Demographic and Health Survey (ENDES/DHS, 1996–2020).
- Applied machine learning to detect corruption in public procurement with Peru's national audit office.

Innovations for Poverty Action (IPA) Lima, Peru
Research Analyst (Nov 2021 – Mar 2023); Research Intern (Aug 2021 – Oct 2021) *Partners: World Bank; IDB*

- Contributed to the design, pre-analysis plans and data collection of RCTs evaluating social-emotional learning, growth mindset tutoring, and intimate partner violence prevention in El Salvador, Nicaragua and Peru.
- Coordinated program deployment and scale-up with government and non-profit partners, and presented findings to them. Supervised field implementation and treatment monitoring, in person and through SurveyCTO.

- Built WhatsApp/Twilio survey and monitoring systems protecting respondent safety; designed a nationwide campaign that encouraged teachers to register for the national teacher-hiring exam.

RESEARCH

Riega, S. (2025). *Not One Less in the Labor Market: The Vulnerability of Women's Employment in Urban Peru in 2019.* PUCP and Peru's Economic and Social Research Consortium (CIES) with UNFPA.

Riega, S. (in progress). *Higher Floors, Same Risks? A Decade of Minimum Wage Increases and Labor Vulnerability in Urban Peru.*

León, J. & Riega, S. (in progress). *Do Digital Learning Platforms Close or Widen Learning Gaps? Evidence from Khan Academy in Lima's Public Schools.*

Acknowledged contributor:

León, J., Endo, J., Zoido, P. & Suarez, S. (2026). *Remote Tutoring for Learning Recovery: Experimental Evidence from a Low-Tech Intervention in Peru.* International Journal of Educational Development, 125, 103654.

Bhatt, M. P., et al. (2025). *Personalized Learning Initiative Interim Report: Findings from 2023–24.* University of Chicago Education Lab.

HONORS AND AWARDS

UNFPA–IDRC Canada–CIES National Research Competition, First Place in Economics (Thesis category) 2025
PUCP Student Research Fund, competitive grant for undergraduate thesis research 2022

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: R (advanced), Stata, Python, SQL; Git, LaTeX, Quarto, SurveyCTO
Languages: Spanish (native), English (fluent)

REFERENCES

Jens Ludwig · Max Kapustin · Fatemeh Momeni · Juan León Jara Almonte